



GYach! is Here

If you are hooked on Yahoo! Messenger because of some of its cool and core features, but also want to keep your hands off Windows, take a look at GYach!

There are many like me who are addicted to instant messaging, a.k.a. chatting. So it's not surprising to find so many IM tools available for GNU systems—Kopete, Pidgin, Empathy, and so much more. They enable you to log into any of the chat services—GTalk, Yahoo!, AIM, MSN and any others. Some are good, while some are not, although I did feel a bit inferior whenever I saw someone on a Mac or Windows machine using the full version of Yahoo! Messenger. This software allows them not only to chat but also use the Web cam, share photos in a live session, send or receive files, log in to chat rooms and much more.

I have used most of the GNU chat clients, but none gave me the kind of satisfaction I needed. And I am not enough of a geek to write one myself. But I am, just like most of you, someone who has the most power—I am the user. And I am a GNU/Linux user. We are quite good compared to those Mac users for whom a computer is as good as a TV. Just turn it on, use it and shut it down. The policy they follow is called 'DADT'—'don't ask; don't tell'... and how it works! It's not wrong to call the TV the idiot box. I don't

know what a Mac ought to be called, though, but Mac users surely deserve as much right to information and *better* software (not just better *looking* versions). Now, Windows users are poor souls. Neither does the software look good, nor does it work well.

So, as a GNU/Linux user, I took a dive into the World Wide Web and came across an IM client with a name not as long as Arnold's last name, but definitely as difficult to pronounce. It's called GYach!. I had never heard of it before—I guess it's just my curiosity that brought us together.

GYach! [gyachi.sourceforge.net] is actually a fork of the Gyach Enhanced Yahoo! client for GNU/Linux operating systems. The project was forked because the original developer got involved with other activities and there was some worry over the future of the project. Well, that is the rule of the Freedom Software world, unlike the proprietary world—no project stops because of an individual or an organisation's unwillingness to take it further. Do you know what the future of Yahoo! would be like after an acquisition by MS, for instance? No. But you do put all your bets on any Freedom Software

Features include

- Web cam support
- Voice chat support
- File sending
- Photo sharing
- Mail notification
- Captcha support—Yahoo 8 onwards uses captchas to enter chat rooms in order to control spam bots.